

# 30 Minutes Expert PC-to-PC

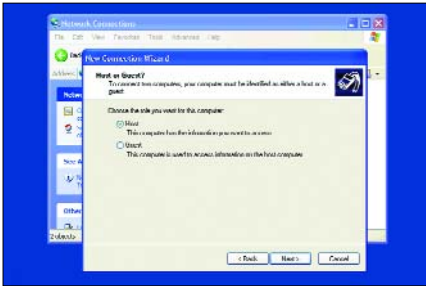
Get two computers to talk the serial or parallel way

Shuttling files from a laptop to a work PC and back again is tedious, isn't it? So, here's a solution—connect them directly. Doing so is easy, cheap and a matter of minutes—30 minutes to be precise!

A Serial Laplink or a Parallel Laplink cable, priced at around Rs 50, is all you need to connect a PC or a laptop directly to another of its own ilk. Here, we use the Serial Laplink. The steps for a Parallel Laplink are similar, and the differences will be highlighted as we proceed further.

**Minute 1:** Connect the two ends of the cable to the serial port of the PC and/or laptop. You can connect the cable even while the computers are powered on.

**Minute 2:** In Control Panel, double-click 'Phone and Modem Options', go to the Modems tab and click Add. Tick the



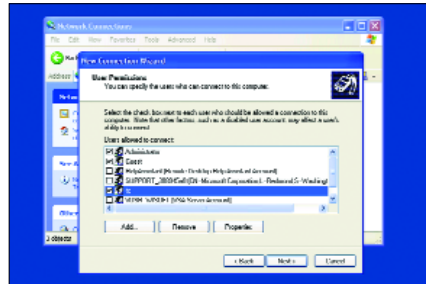
This step in the wizard lets you specify the direction of control

'Don't detect my modem; I will select it from list' option, and click Next.

**Minute 3:** Since it's a serial cable, we select 'Communications cable between two computers'. Click Next to select the port to which the cable is connected. Finally, click Finish.

**Minutes 4-5:** Repeat the steps from Minutes 2 to 3 on the other PC or laptop as well.

**Minute 6:** Double-click Network Connections in Control Panel, and start the 'New



Select the appropriate port—the one where the cable is connected

Connection Wizard'.

**Minute 7:** Select 'Set up an advanced connection' in the 'Network Connection Type' list and click Next.

**Minute 8:** In the 'Advanced Connection Options', select 'Connect directly to another computer'.

**Minute 9:** Specify your PC as Host or Guest and click Next. One PC has to play host and the other has to be the guest. You cannot use a PC as a guest and a host simultaneously.

**Minute 10:** Here, the type of cable decides your selection. Select COMx if it's a Laplink serial cable or LPTx otherwise. The x stands for a numeric value such as 1, 2... Generally, the mouse is connected to the COM1 port, so the serial cable uses the COM2 port. Click Next.

**Minute 11:** Now, specify the users who can connect to the host using this connection. You can even create a new user especially for this purpose. Enable the users, click on Next, and finally,

**TIP** The 'Computer name' is the name you assign your PC while installing Windows. Windows XP users will find it by right-clicking My Computer and going to **Properties > Computer Name**. In Windows 98, right-click Network Neighbourhood and go to the Identification tab.



Double-click on the guest icon to connect to the remote computer

Finish to complete the Wizard.

**Minute 12:** Start up the Wizard yet again and repeat the steps from Minutes 6 to 8. A Host or Guest screen appears. Here, select Guest this time.

**Minute 13:** When prompted, specify the name of the remote computer connected at the other end of the cable.

**Minute 14:** Here, select the data port on which the computer is connected.

**Info** Here's the concept behind the host and guest: A guest PC can access files from the host PC. However, the reverse is not possible.

**Minute 15-23:** Repeat steps from Minute 6 to Minute 14 on the other computer as well.

**Minute 24:** This done, a pair of connections appears in the Network Connections window. One within Direct, the guest connection—and another within Incoming, which represents the host connection.

**Minute 25:** Double-click the guest connection and specify the username and the password. This username should exist on the remote machine.

**Minute 26:** Finally, on the guest PC, go to **Start > Run** and type \\computername\ to access the remote computer.

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